



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2023 Version B for STA 301 - INTRODUCTION TO DATA SCIENCE (05350) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2023**

Courses Audience: **60**

Responses Received: **28**

Response Ratio: **46.7%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

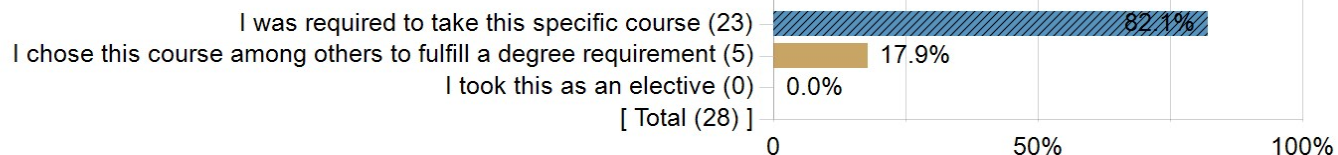
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

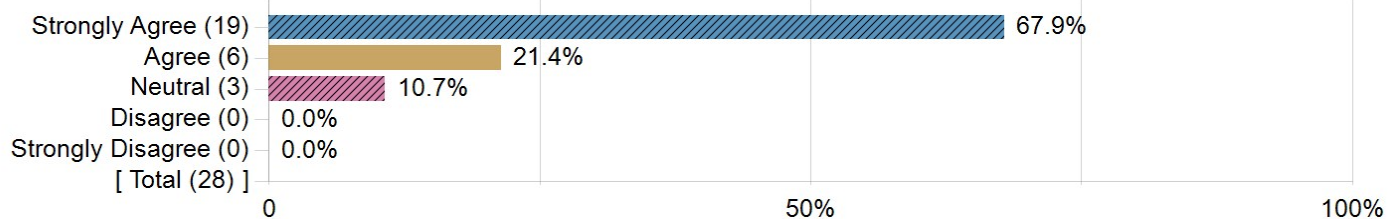
Creation Date: **Sunday, January 21, 2024**

Course Questions

Why did you take this course?



During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.



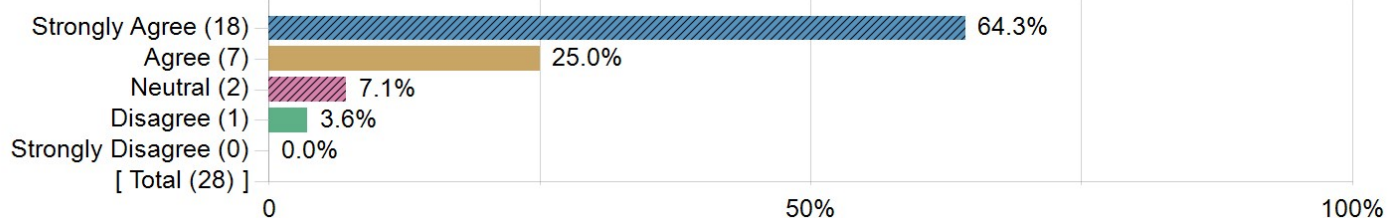
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.57

The course was well organized.



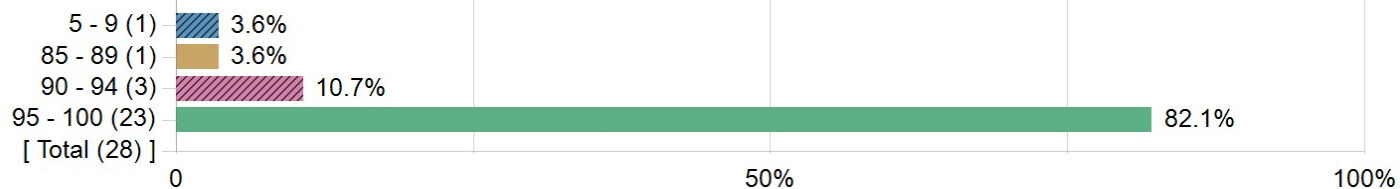
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.50

Overall, approximately what percentage of the course meetings did you attend or complete (online, in person, or asynchronously)?



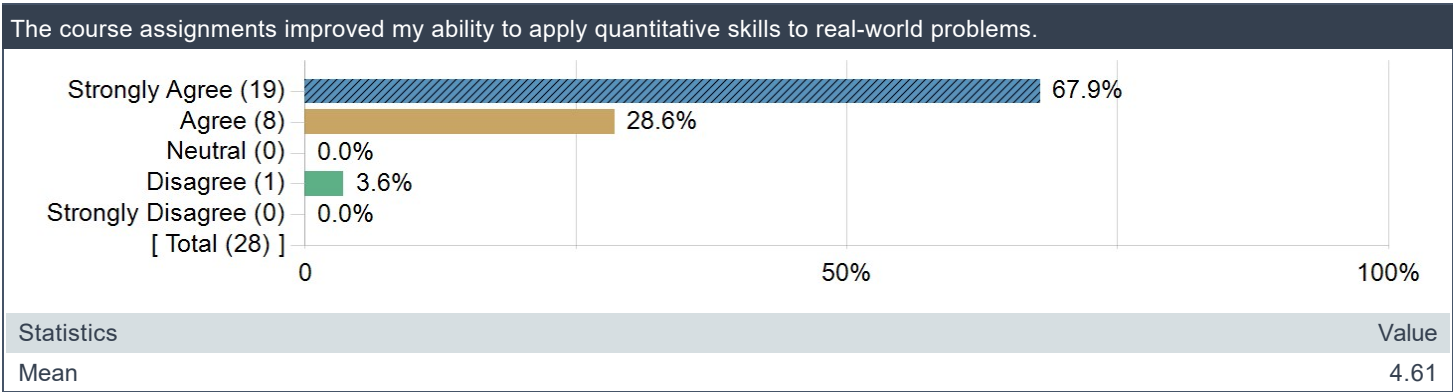
Statistics

Value

Mean

93.32

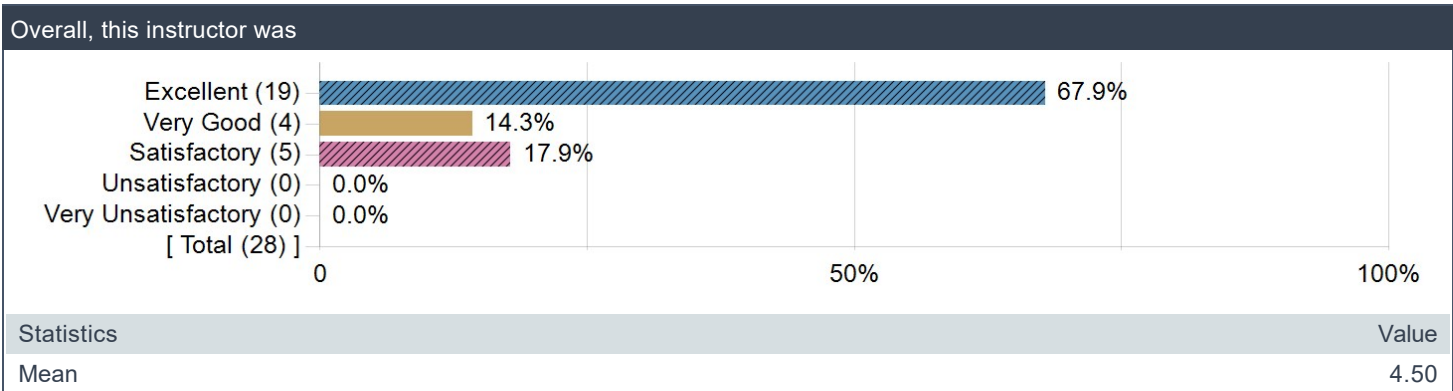
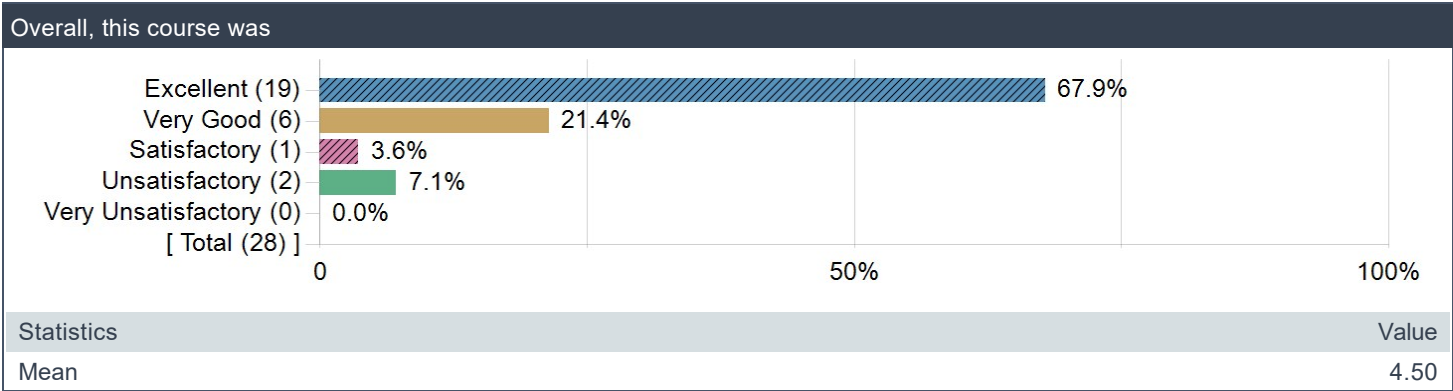
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



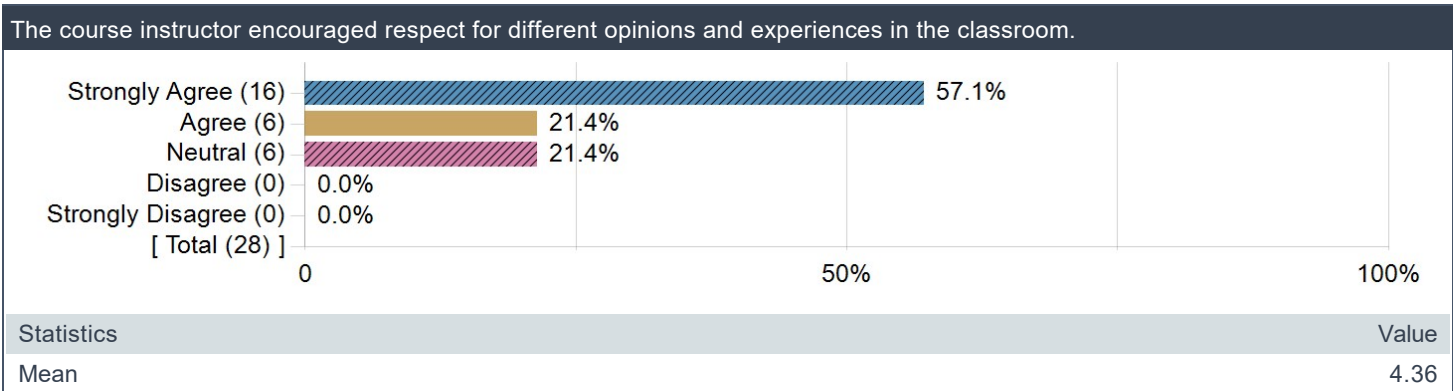
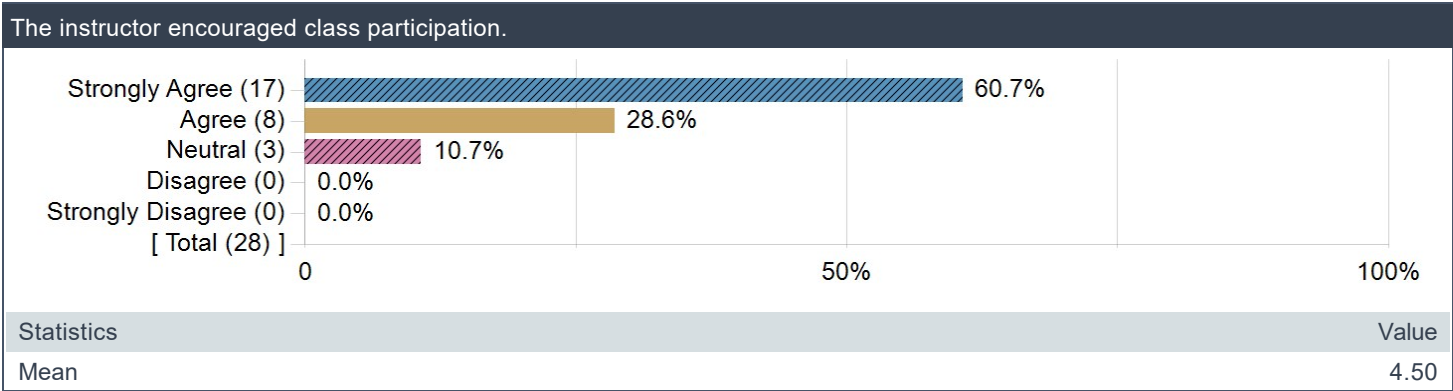
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	60.7%	25.0%	14.3%	0.0%	0.0%	28	4.46
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	64.3%	28.6%	3.6%	3.6%	0.0%	28	4.54
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	64.3%	10.7%	21.4%	3.6%	0.0%	28	4.36
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	57.1%	21.4%	21.4%	0.0%	0.0%	28	4.36
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	71.4%	21.4%	7.1%	0.0%	0.0%	28	4.64

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
The textbook alongside the slides and lectures
Reliable TA's
Knowledge checks after class.
The class sessions becoming r studio seminars was helpful.
the assignments due weekly
TA information meetings
How he would complete the R scripts with us and explain them as we went on.
The textbook was great! Also the TAs (and Dr. Bolfarine) are very helpful when I asked questions.
Learning a new coding technique provided a cognitive thinking challenge.
completing the knowledge checks and homework
Rstudio practice sessions
Explanation of codes
Professor Bolfarine was amazing in the way he taught the class. He always made it engaging and funny while making sure everyone understood the concepts. This made it fun to attend class and also pay attention. We had homework after every class which was in charge of making sure we knew the concepts and understood the content of the class.
KCs
I enjoyed the KCs because they made me figure out how to do the work myself to complete the questions.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
KCs and HWs could be quite challenging. KCs could be less often, maybe once a week.
it was hard to learn because i was not used to coding, it was my first time
Finishing tests in the time limit.
I feel like the class was taught directly out of the book, so if I was having trouble understanding the textbook, I was also confused in class.
The aspect of the course that I found most challenging was the homeworks.
learning r studio
The homeworks were the most challenging. The professor going over the homeworks to answer questions could be helpful.
Learning a foreign coding language, staying on top of the readings helps to learn it
Reading the textbook
None
The aspect of the class that was the most challenging was probably the 4 "Homework" grades that we got as they were long and required a lot of critical thinking skills. However this did really help me when it came to reinforcing concepts in my head which made life easier towards midterm season.
I think the most difficult part was working with R because you really have to pay attention in class and not miss any lessons to make sure you understand each section of the material.